

in 1965 and again in 1967.

To ensure would-be recruits had the necessary physical and mental stamina, they were put through rigorous training at the Parris Island Recruit Depot, South Carolina, or its sister establishment in San Diego, California. The four-month program included an 80-day boot camp—cut to 60 days during parts of the war—beginning with an obligatory hair cut and drill. Further training in combat skills included long-range shooting, a specialty of Marines. This included learning the Rifleman's Creed, a guiding doctrine avowing the pact between man and gun. After this, they were deployed for their first 13-month tour of duty.

GRUNT Slang for a member of the Marine Corps fighting in Vietnam. Later in the war, it was applied to all US soldiers on the frontline.



Flying ace

This Marine Corps patch shows Charles Schultz's cartoon character Snoopy flying an Mk4 pod gun, a weapon mounted on the exterior of various models of US Navy and Marine attack aircraft.